

Assignment 1: Market Research – Dog Adoption

Objective

To understand the dog adoption process from a user's perspective and learn about the people, organizations, and steps involved.

Introduction

Dog adoption is the process of giving homeless or rescued dogs a permanent home through shelters and NGOs. It supports animal welfare and encourages responsible pet ownership.

Stakeholders

Adopter, Animal Shelters/NGOs, Veterinarians, and Volunteers each play an important role in rescuing, caring for, and rehoming dogs.

Dog Adoption Process

1. Search for a dog. 2. View dog profile. 3. Submit an adoption application. 4. Shelter verifies the applicant. 5. Meet the dog. 6. Approval and agreement. 7. Bring the dog home. 8. Post-adoption follow-up.

Dog Profile Information

A profile typically includes the dog's name, breed, age, gender, size, personality, health status, vaccination records, sterilization status, medical history, shelter location, and photos.

Challenges for Adopters

Finding nearby shelters, outdated listings, limited health information, slow communication, and lengthy approval processes.

Challenges for Shelters

Managing many dogs, maintaining health records, updating profiles, limited staff, funding constraints, and post-adoption monitoring.

User Needs

Easy navigation, accurate dog information, verified health records, search filters, application tracking, messaging, notifications, and adoption guidance.

Key Insights

Trust, transparency, and up-to-date information are essential. A simple adoption process and effective communication improve the user experience.

Conclusion

Understanding the dog adoption domain helps UX designers identify user needs and pain points before designing a digital solution. Good research leads to better design decisions and improves the adoption experience for both adopters and shelters.